

String.prototype.search()

The **search()** method executes a search for a match between a regular expression and this [String](#) object.

Try it

JavaScript Demo: String.search()

```
1 const paragraph = 'The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog. If the dog ba
2
3 // any character that is not a word character or whitespace
4 const regex = /^[^\w\s]/g;
5
6 console.log(paragraph.search(regex));
7 // expected output: 43
8
9 console.log(paragraph[paragraph.search(regex)]);
10 // expected output: "."
11
```

Run › Reset

Syntax

search(*regexp*)

Parameters

regexp

A regular expression object, or any object that has a [Symbol.search](#) method.

If *regexp* is not a [RegExp](#) object and does not have a [Symbol.search](#) method, it is implicitly converted to a [RegExp](#) by using `new RegExp(regexp)`.

Return value

The index of the first match between the regular expression and the given string, or `-1` if no match was found.

Description

The implementation of `String.prototype.search()` itself is very simple — it simply calls the `Symbol.search` method of the argument with the string as the first parameter. The actual implementation comes from [RegExp.prototype\[@@search\]\(\)](#).